honest and industrious life and refrain from consuming alcohol in public places, on the basis that they were vague and hard to enforce.[40]

The high court decisively rejected Gill's argument that the prosecution's narrative should be rejected in the absence of corroborating witnesses. However, in arriving at its decision, the court reinforced stereotypes and prejudices. Much of the high court's judgement was directed towards the humiliation associated with what others would think if a woman was sexually harassed, not the trauma that is inherent in being harassed. The judgement offers a catalogue of examples of this: '[An] Indian woman is a symbol of modesty itself. Every part of her body symbolises that she is the specimen of modesty';[41] 'Mrs Bajaj is a woman of the society and in our society still the woman is regarded as a symbol of modesty';[42] 'she cannot accept insult, specially in an elite gathering, otherwise a wrong signal can travel in the elite itself';[43] 'she was humiliated in the presence of others and it was very difficult on her part to swallow it, lest there may be encouragement to the petitioner or lest a wrong signal may travel in the respectable society about her conduct';[44] 'keeping in view the traditions of our country, specially in northern India, no respectable woman would come forward with false allegations';[45] '[t]he alleged act was going to be committed qua a woman, who possibly could not digest the humiliation and the consequences of the act allegedly performed by the petitioner'.[46]

Both Gill and Bajaj decided to appeal against the high court's decision. For Bajaj, Gill had been let off the hook too easily. For Gill, nothing short of exoneration was acceptable. Another long delay between the high court's decision and the Supreme Court's decision followed. The Supreme Court made its decision on 27 July 2005, seventeen years and nine days after the party at the Kapur residence. The final judgement in this case, delivered by Justices Balakrishnan and Srikrishna, was short and succinct. The court rejected the argument that the criminal proceedings were an attempt to malign Gill and observed that his conduct was not befitting that of a top-ranking police officer. Neither Gill's nor Bajaj's final appeals were successful. The high court's decision stood – Gill was convicted, but would not go to prison.